automatically from a DHCP router/modem (meaning that you need to fill in a static IP address for network access), or you need to enter your wireless access keys, you can do it here.

We have made sure that most of the Broadcom and Intel Wi-Fi cards should work out-of-the-box. In fact, if you're on a wireless network or need to frequently change your IP address, it's wiser to set up a tool called NetworkManager. Launch YaST, enter 'network' in the search bar and double click on the icon that reads **Network Settings**. You can 'Edit' your network settings in the **Overview** tab. To turn on the NetworkManager, switch to the Global Options tab and select the option that reads "User Controlled with NetworkManager". Then hit the **OK** button.

You should get a pop-up message near the system clock at the bottom right side of the screen that would report about a certain change. Locate an icon with an unplugged network wire in the system tray and configure your wireless/wired network there. The appearance of the icon should change to show a 'connecting', and then 'connected' status.

Tip: If by chance it fails after you're done with configuring the settings, log out (not restart) from the desktop and re-login as the live CD user 'tux' using the password linux, and try to connect to the network again. It should definitely work.

But this is only useful when the OS is on your hard drive and not on RAM, right? Which brings us to...

How about installing it on your hard drive?

Hit Alt+F2 and type 'live'. Yes, launch the **Live Installer** application to put the entire OS on your hard drive. There are two reasons for installing it:

1. Things will get a lot faster
2. Your changes will stay across reboots

Why? Because, right now everything is on the RAM—so it's heavily loaded—and the reason for everything seeming (sometimes, horribly) slow is lack of free memory. And, again, because everything is on the RAM, it all vanishes when you turn off your system.

The instructions on the installer are pretty simple and straightforward. The only place where you need some help is the partition screen on this installer wizard—i.e., only if you haven't installed a GNU/Linux system before. You should have at least 4 GB of free space on your hard drive where you can install the OS. Proceed only if you do. Else, free up some space using your preferred method.

On the partition screen, click on the button that says **Create Partition**; the next screen will show your hard disk, followed by a screen displaying your partition table. Select the free partition and delete it! Now hit **Add** to create a new partition. Choose **Custom size** and enter 1GB there, before hitting **Next**. In the following screen, select the file system type as **Swap** from the drop down menu and click **Finish**. Again, hit **Add** to create another partition. Let it be the maximum size this time, and click **Next**. Let the file system type be ext3 now, and instead click on the option that reads "Mount partition". Enter / (i.e., slash from your keyboard) and hit **Finish**. That's it — you've successfully prepared your hard disk to install the OS.

This is, of course, not the best partition set-up. If you're interested to know more about partitions, go to http://tldp.org/HOWTO/Partition/

The rest of the installation wizard is simple. The time taken to copy the OS to your hard disk depends on your system speed. On a relatively new system with good hardware specs, it won't take more than 10 minutes. When it's all over, you should get a pop-up indicating the same and that you should reboot and then remove the CD from the CD tray.

Upon restarting your computer, the system will configure a few things and you'll land straight in the brand new desktop. There are a few more steps if you are one of those using the notorious Nvidia or ATI graphics chipsets. Follow the instructions at:

- *http://en.opensuse.org/NVIDIA*
- *http://en.opensuse.org/Howto/ATI_Driver*

...to set up your display drivers. Note that the version of openSUSE OS you're using is 11.1.

Tip: Your Firefox, GIMP image editor and OpenOffice.org suite will look ugly out-of-the-box (they are not native KDE applications). To make them look decent, launch the **Configure Desktop** utility, access the **Appearance** section and navigate to GTK Styles and Fonts. Set your style settings there—I prefer the **Clearlooks** style—and **Apply**. It'll prompt you to log out for the changes to take effect. Do that, and you're done.

While we're still here, I'd recommend you go to the *Fonts* settings section and change the fixed-width font from Monospace to Liberation Mono. This fixes the issue with the cursor position in Konsole.

So there you are; your free software operating system is up and running. Now, honestly tell me how long would it have taken you if you had wanted the same functionality on your freshly-installed Winduhs system. With that, I rest my case.

P.S.: You can read a review of KDE 4.3 on the following pages. END

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